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TO: Paul Milewski, Department Head and Professor

FROM: Jack Huizenga, Associate Professor

DATE: October 2, 2024

SUBJECT: Teaching evaluation of Christopher-Lloyd Simon

I visited Christopher-Lloyd Simon's section of MATH 141 on Monday, September 30 at 4:40 PM. In this class, Simon discussed the several possible indeterminate forms of limits at infinity, and how to use L'Hospital's rule to compute them. Often this required converting a problem where L'Hospital's rule could not obviously be applied into a different form first. Overall, my impression of Simon's teaching is very good.

I met Simon on his way over to the classroom, and we arrived a few minutes ahead of the class time. There were between 15 and 20 students in attendance. He interacted with a couple of students before the class, and then began lecturing. He recalled the indeterminate forms of limits from the previous lecture, and then worked several examples. His board work is good although it was a bit hard to read because the chalkboard light was not turned on. While working examples, he got the students to lead him to the next step in many of the computations. This was very good.

Simon then switched to discussing the growth rates of functions at infinity. In my opinion this discussion was a little too abstract and technical, and it would have been better to do some more examples instead of doing any (admittedly simple) proofs. Simon stopped lecturing with 10 minutes left and had the students work on a worksheet which was mostly related to the material from the first part of the lecture. In my opinion it would have been better to have them work on the problems earlier in the lecture to break things up a bit, and then he could have finished with the new material on growth rates.

Overall, Simon did a very good job and I have no major concerns about his teaching.

Best,

Jack Huizenga
Associate Professor of Mathematics

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